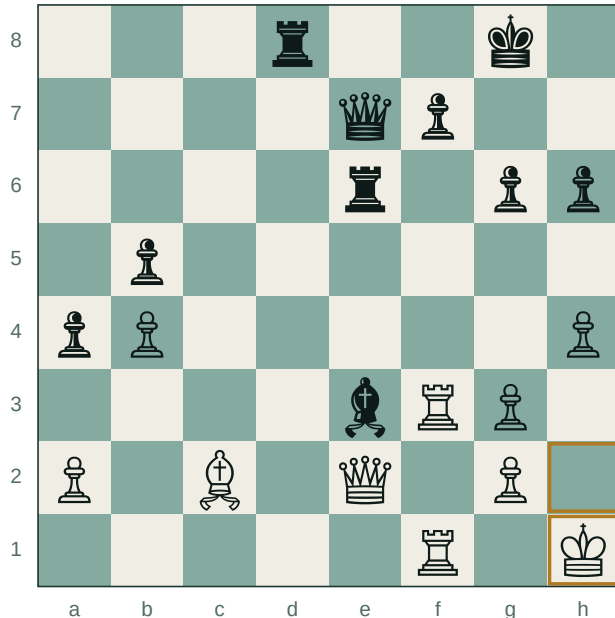


Interference tactics: Black, move 30

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 30.Kh1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...Rd2 31. Qxb5 Rxc2

30...Rd2 The rook moves from d8 to d2. From d2 it attacks queen on e2 and bishop on c2. Recorded reply: **31.Qxb5**.

31...Rxc2 The rook captures the bishop on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e2. Check for tactical protection.